

.32 ACP

.32 ACP (Automatic Colt Pistol, also known as **.32 Automatic**) is a centerfire pistol cartridge. It is a semi-rimmed, straight-walled cartridge developed by firearms designer John Browning, initially for use in the FN M1900 semi-automatic pistol. It was introduced in 1899 by Fabrique Nationale, and is also known as the **7.65×17mmSR Browning** or **7.65 mm Browning Short**.^[5]

History

John Browning engineered a number of modern semi-automatic pistol mechanisms and cartridges. As his first pistol cartridge, the .32 ACP needed a straight wall for reliable blowback operation as well as a small rim for reliable feeding from a box magazine. The cartridge headspaces on the rim.^[6] The cartridge was a success and was adopted by dozens of countries and many governmental agencies.

When the .32 ACP cartridge was introduced, it was immediately popular and was available in several blowback automatic pistols of the day, including the Colt Model 1903 Pocket Hammerless, the Savage Model 1907 automatic pistol, the Ruby pistol and the Browning Model 1910 automatic pistol. The popularity of the .32 ACP in the early half of the 20th century cannot be overstated—especially in Europe. Firearms expert Geoffrey Boothroyd, of the UK, informed author Ian Fleming, his countryman, that James Bond's sidearm should be a Walther PPK chambered in .32 ACP. A significant factor in recommending this round was its availability throughout the world in the 1950s.^[7]

The .32 ACP has been chambered in more handguns than any other cartridge. Between 1899 and 1909, Fabrique Nationale produced 500,000 guns chambered for .32 ACP.^[8]

Heckler & Koch produced the HK 4, their first handgun, in 1967. 12,000 HK 4 pistols were produced in .32 ACP for the German police and other government agencies.

Several long guns have been chambered in .32 ACP, from the Tirmax and Dreyse carbines to the AR-15-style Armi Jager AP-74.

Design

The .32 ACP was intended for blowback semi-automatic pistols, which lack breech locking mechanisms. It was John Pedersen with the Remington Model 51 that delivered a true locked breech for

.32 ACP	
	
Standard (left) and nickel-coated military (right) full metal jacket (FMJ) .32 ACP rounds	
Type	Pistol
Place of origin	United States
Production history	
Designer	<u>John Browning</u>
Manufacturer	<u>Fabrique Nationale</u>
Produced	1899–present
Specifications	
Case type	Semi-rimmed, straight
Bullet diameter	.3125 in (7.94 mm)
Land diameter	.3005 in (7.63 mm)
Neck diameter	.3365 in (8.55 mm)
Base diameter	.337 in (8.6 mm)
Rim diameter	.358 in (9.1 mm)
Rim thickness	.045 in (1.1 mm)
Case length	.680 in (17.3 mm)

the .32 ACP cartridge. The low power and light bullet of the cartridge allowed Browning to incorporate a practical blowback mechanism in a small pocket-size pistol. It is still used today, primarily in compact, inexpensive pistols, unless the pistol is used for ISSF competition, where the cost then escalates. Cartridges in .32 ACP are also sometimes used in caliber conversion sleeves, also known as *supplemental chambers*, for providing an alternative pistol caliber carbine function in .30-caliber hunting and service rifles.

Some comparison of the .32 Automatic as defined by SAAMI and the 7.65 Browning as defined by CIP may be useful. Although some of the cartridge measurements differ by as much as 0.16 mm, the names are considered to be synonymous. However, the maximum average pressure - as measured by a transducer on the test barrel - is 20,500 psi (1,410 bar) according to SAAMI, while CIP allows up to 1,600 bar (23,000 psi). This may explain why the cartridges from European manufacturers tend to chronograph at higher muzzle velocities than those from American manufacturers.

Performance

The .32 ACP is compact and light. While some believe it has marginal stopping power,^[9] it has been used effectively by military and police worldwide for the past century. Although .32 ACP handguns were traditionally made of steel, they have been produced in lightweight polymers since the 1990s. Their light weight, very low recoil and very good accuracy relative to larger caliber pistols make them suitable for concealed carry use. Some popular pistols chambered in .32 ACP are the Walther PP and the Walther PPK as well as the FEG PA-63, which is a clone of the Walther PP.

It offers more velocity and energy than the .32 S&W, which was a popular round for pocket defensive revolvers at the time of the .32 ACP's development. Although with lighter bullet weights, the .32 ACP also compares favorably to the .32 S&W Long in performance. Some European 73-grain .32 ACP loads provide similar performance to the .32 H&R Magnum 77-grain lead flat point and 90-grain lead semiwadcutter.

Even though the .32 ACP is capable of killing small game, most handguns chambered for this round utilize fixed sights and are designed for use against human-sized targets at fairly close range, which greatly limits their utility as hunting handguns.

.32 ACP is one of the most common calibers used in veterinary "humane killers", such as the Greener humane killer.

In Europe, where the round is commonly known as the 7.65mm Browning and features a different rimsizing, .32 ACP has always been more widely accepted than it has in America, having a long history of use by civilians, law enforcement personnel, and security forces, along with limited issue by military forces.^[5] During the second half of the 20th century, several European countries developed firearms for

Overall length	.984 in (25.0 mm)	
Primer type	Small pistol	
Maximum pressure	20,500 psi (141 MPa)	
Ballistic performance		
Bullet mass/type	Velocity	Energy
60 gr (4 g) <u>JHP^[1]</u>	1,100 ft/s (335 m/s)	161 ft·lbf (218 J)
65 gr (4 g) <u>JHP^[2]</u>	925 ft/s (282 m/s)	123 ft·lbf (167 J)
71 gr (5 g) <u>FMJ^[3]</u>	984 ft/s (300 m/s)	158 ft·lbf (214 J)
73 gr (5 g) <u>FMJ^[4]</u>	1,043 ft/s (318 m/s)	177 ft·lbf (240 J)
Test barrel length: 4 in, ^[1] 4 in, ^[2] 5.9 in, ^[3] 3.9 in ^[4]		
Source(s): ^[1] ^[2] ^[3] ^[4]		



.32 ACP (left) next to a .380 ACP (right)

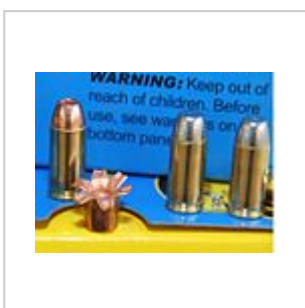
police, chambered in 9×18mm Makarov while chambering the same pistol for civilians in .32 ACP and .380 ACP. Examples include the Vz. 82/CZ-83 from Czechoslovakia, FEG PA-63/AP 765 from Hungary, SIG Sauer P230 from Switzerland, and P-83 Wanad from Poland.

Today the cartridge has an increased popularity in the United States due to modern compact concealed carry pistols chambered for it, such as the Kel-Tec P-32, Beretta Tomcat, Seecamp LWS 32 and North American Arms Guardian .32. This increase in popularity has led many ammunition manufacturers to develop new loads for the cartridge to increase performance. However, these subcompact guns typically have barrel lengths around 2.5 inches. The traditional steel guns chambered for .32 ACP have barrel lengths around 3.5 inches. Different barrel lengths can have a significant effect on bullet performance with longer barrels providing higher muzzle velocity and energy. For example, a Cor-Bon 60-grain .32 ACP JHP has 130 foot pounds of energy when fired out of a 2.5-inch barrel and 165 foot pounds of energy when fired out of a 3.5-inch barrel.^[10] A shorter barrel length can also reduce the range of a bullet.

Gallery



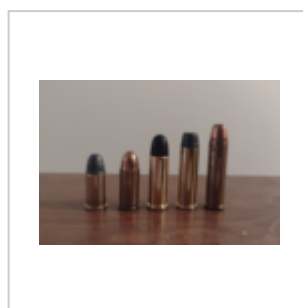
.32 ACP cartridge



Modern versions of the .32 ACP include heavier bullets with advanced expansion



.380 ACP (left) next to a .32 ACP (right)



From left to right: .32 Short, .32 ACP, .32 S&W Long, .32 H&R Magnum and .327 Federal Magnum.

Synonyms

- .32 Auto (typical designation in the USA)
- .32 Browning Auto
- .32 Rimless Smokeless (Used on early pistols chambered for it)^[11]
- 7.65 mm Browning (typical designation in Europe)
- 7.65×17mm
- 7.65×17mm Browning SR (SR = Semi-Rimmed)
- 7.65 Walther

Prominent firearms chambered in .32 ACP

- | | |
|---|--|
| ▪ <u>Astra A-60</u> | ▪ <u>Beretta Model 81 and 82</u> |
| ▪ <u>Bayard 1908</u> | ▪ <u>Beretta Model 90</u> ^[13] |
| ▪ <u>Beretta 3032 Tomcat</u> | ▪ <u>Bersa 84 (Lusber)</u> |
| ▪ <u>Beretta M1915</u> | ▪ <u>Bersa Thunder 32</u> |
| ▪ <u>Beretta M1935</u> | ▪ <u>Colt Model 1903 Pocket Hammerless</u> |
| ▪ <u>Beretta Model 70</u> ^[12] | ▪ <u>CZ-27 (Vz. 27)</u> |

- [CZ-50](#)
- [CZ-70](#)
- [CZ-83](#)
- [CZ Škorpion Vz. 61 Machine pistol](#)
- [Dreyse M1907](#)
- [Erma KGP-68A "Baby Luger"](#)
- [FÉG 37M Pistol](#)
- [FÉG AP 765 Pistol^{\[a\]}](#)
- [FÉG Frommer Stop](#)
- [FN M1900](#)
- [FN Model 1910 and 1910/22](#)
- [Hamada Type pistol](#)
- [Heckler & Koch HK 4 P11](#)
- [Heckler & Koch HK P7K3](#)
- [Jieffeco Model 1911](#)
- [Kel-Tec P-32](#)
- [Llama Bufalo/Danton/Llama I/Llama X-A](#)
- [MAB Model D](#)
- [Mauser HSc](#)
- [Mauser Model 1914](#)
- [Mauser Model 1934](#)
- [Ortgies Semi-Automatic Pistol](#)
- [Oznobischev 1925](#)
- [Pardini HP](#)
- [Radom P-83 Wanad](#)
- [Remington 51](#)
- [Romanian Pistol Carpați Md. 1974](#)
- [Ruby](#)
- [Sauer 38H](#)
- [Savage Model 1907](#)
- [Seecamp LWS 32](#)
- [SIG Sauer P230](#)
- [Star Izarra](#)
- [Star Model 1914/1919](#)
- [Star SIS](#)
- [Steyr-Pieper Model 1908/34](#)
- [Taurus Millennium PT132](#)
- [Taurus TCP 732](#)
- [Taurus PT57](#)
- [Walther PP](#)
- [Walther PPK](#)
- [Webley & Scott M1905-M1908^{\[14\]}](#)
- [Welrod](#)
- [Zastava M70](#)

See also

- [.32 NAA](#)
- [7 mm caliber](#) for other cartridges of similar diameter (7.0 - 7.99 mm diameter)
- [Derringer](#)
- [List of handgun cartridges](#)
- [Table of handgun and rifle cartridges](#)

Notes

- a. The FÉG AP 765 is a variant of the FÉG PA-63.

References

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External links

- Is The .32 Mission Feasible? (<http://shilohtv.com/?p=2720>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20130703063732/http://shilohtv.com/?p=2720>) 2013-07-03 at the Wayback Machine
 - Ballistics 101 .32 ACP Ballistics Chart (http://www.ballistics101.com/32_acp.php)
 - Ballistics By The Inch .32 ACP Results (<http://www.ballisticsbytheinch.com/32auto.html>)
 - Brass Fetcher .32 ACP Gelatin Tests (<http://www.brassfetcher.com/Handguns/32%20ACP/32%20ACP.html>)
 - Golden Loki .32 ACP Gelatin Tests (Archived) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20130320185813/http://www.goldenloki.com/ammo/gel/32acp/gel32acp.htm>)
 - Mouse Gun Addict Ammo Tests (<http://mousegunaddict.blogspot.com/p/ammo-tests.html>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20131003154718/http://mousegunaddict.blogspot.com/p/ammo-tests.html>) 2013-10-03 at the Wayback Machine
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